



CHAPTER 2

THE NATURAL WORLD

When the Earth was brand-new, more than 4,500 million years ago, there were violent storms, lightning bolts, and fiery volcanoes on its surface, but there was no life. In time, oceans formed, and it was here that the first life appeared in the form of simple organisms called bacteria and algae. Soon, more complex life-forms developed and, by about 600 million years ago, the seas were alive with soft-bodied animals. Later, other animals developed hard shells and skeletons, and small plants began to grow on the shores.

Insects and similar creatures were the first animals on land, followed by amphibians (which live in water and on land), then reptiles, birds, and mammals. It was not until quite recently—about four million years ago—that the first upright-walking ancestors of humans appeared.

Plant Life
Sea Life
Insects and Spiders
Dinosaurs
Birds
Mammals
The Human Body

